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LVNA Villager

WELCOME TO THE NEWSLETTER OF THE LAKEWOOD VILLAGE NEIGHBORHOOD ASSOCIATION



LVNA Special Event Ice Cream Social! Meet the AD26 Candidates - Feb 10

Our District 26 (AD26) California State Assemblymember Evan Low's current term expires in 2024. Low has announced he is running for the Congressional House of Representatives District 16 seat and will not be running for re-election for California State Assembly. There are six candidates running for his seat in the primary election on March 5, 2024: three Democrats (Patrick Ahrens, Omar Din, and Tara Sreekrishnan), one Republican (Sophie Yan Song), one Libertarian (Bob Goodwyn), and one with no party affiliation (Ashish Garg).

The LVNA Board has organized a "meet & greet / Q&A" ice cream party with the candidates for Lakewood residents on Saturday, February 10 from 2:00-3:30pm at the Lakewood Park Building. Patrick, Omar, Tara, and Sophie will all be there. Please come meet the candidates, learn more about them, and tell them what's important to you. RSVPs are helpful but not required. Contact vp1@lvnasv.org to RSVP or to ask questions.

LVNA Board Elections - April 10

Are you passionate (or even just interested in) our neighborhood? Do you enjoy meeting new neighbors? Would you be willing to help build a tight-knit (Lakewood) Village for yourself, your friends, and the next generation who's currently growing up right outside your door or even in your own backyard?

Please join the LVNA board! There are five board positions: President, 1st Vice President, 2nd Vice President, Treasurer, and Secretary. The current board's positions end in April and a new board will begin. The board meets once per month to discuss ongoing activities, in addition to holding quarterly neighborhood general meetings and a few seasonal events each year. The level of commitment is up to each individual - these are all volunteer roles. It is a one-year term (April 2024 - March 2025). The only requirements are that you are 18+ years old, live in the neighborhood, and are able to serve the full 12 month term. Elections are April 10 at 7:00pm in the Lakewood Park Building. For more information, please email board@lvnasv.org

Our Sign is Fixed!

Have you noticed? The entry sign to the Fairwood side of our neighborhood is finally fixed!! For years, it read "Lakew od Village" instead of "Lakewood Village." A huge thank you to Jorge and Heath, who both grew up in Lakewood, from the City of Sunnyvale and the Department of Public Works for replacing the missing letter. Check it out next time you drive by.





Recap of Jan 10 General Meeting

Our first general meeting of the year was on January 10 at 7:00pm at the Lakewood Park Building. Our guest speaker was one of our favorites - Bailey Hall, from the City's Department of Environmental Services. She treated us to an evening of "Talkin' Trash: Diving Into Garbage, Recycling, and Organics." Here are some highlights:

- Did you know that Sunnyvale doesn't have a landfill? The Sunnyvale landfill reached capacity and closed down in 1993. Today, all of our trash goes to the SMaRT station, where it gets sorted. The garbage is compacted and goes to the Kirby Canyon Landfill in Gilroy.
- The SMaART station turned 30 years old in October 2023! It processes 1000 tons of material each day (which includes everything it gets from Sunnyvale and Mountain View). We have a 68% diversion rate, meaning that 68% of the material that goes to the SMaRT station gets sent somewhere besides the landfill.
- Sunnyvale's goal is to reach a 90% diversion rate, which qualifies us to be "zero waste."
- Not everything that can be recycled should be recycled. For example, technically, Styrofoam is recyclable, but the market and demand for recycled Styrofoam is extremely small and unstable. Since people use way more Styrofoam than the recycling market can support, Styrofoam should go in the garbage.
- Less than 10% of single-use plastics get recycled
- Different cities have different methods of communication. San Jose tells people to throw everything in bins and then it gets sorted off-site. Sunnyvale tells people what actually can and can't get recycled. This makes it easier to sort at the SMaRT station, and it keeps us honest about where our trash actually goes.
- Glass and metal can get recycled over and over. Paper can be recycled, but only a handful of times. Plastic can be recycled 1-2 times before it is no longer recyclable.

Meeting recap continued on page 4.



What is Measure C?

The March 5 Primary Election includes the opportunity to vote on Measure C, a $214 million school bond for Sunnyvale School District (SSD) schools. Measure C will provide funds to renovate older schools, make campuses more accessible, improve instructional technology, develop additional counseling areas to support students' mental health, and increase campus safety and security at schools in the District. Measure C needs 55% of voter approval to take effect, and the average yearly cost to property owners in Sunnyvale SD will be $15 per $100,000 of assessed valuation (not market value). The full text of Measure C can be found in your March 5 ballot and is available here: http://tinyurl.com/MeasureCtext Additional information on Measure C can be found at https://supportsunnyvaleschools.org/about/



Proposed Sunnyvale On-Demand Shuttle (Silicon Valley Hopper)

Silicon Valley (SV) Hopper is an on-demand electric shuttle program that already runs well in Cupertino and Santa Clara. At the January 9 Sunnyvale City Council meeting, there were several public comments about extending the SV Hopper to Sunnyvale. An extension to Sunnyvale would provide on-demand transportation for seniors, disabled residents, high school students, and everyone else in Sunnyvale. For example, it could provide Homestead and Fremont students safe, timely rides home from extracurricular activities.



In the Jan 9 meeting, Council voted to agendize the SV Hopper grant as a budget amendment. An update was also given for Study DPW 23-06, which was funded last year to investigate a shuttle service for FHS and HHS students who live in North Sunnyvale. The City has made minimal progress on DPW 23-06, despite Council support and having funds available for the last 8 months. Since the City has stalled on DPW 23-06, a partnership with SV Hopper provides an alternative way to meet the transportation needs of FHS and HHS students in North Sunnyvale. If Sunnyvale invests in this effort, it will be eligible for matching funds through CalSTA grants. Sunnyvale can also join the City of Cupertino's renewal submission effort, which would allow shuttles to be running in time for the 2024-2025 school year. These shuttles would be available to everyone in Sunnyvale for a small per-ride fee. By acting quickly, the City can meet the needs of students and residents throughout Sunnyvale who cannot or choose not to drive. If you would like to provide feedback on how the on-demand SV Hopper shuttle would benefit you or your family, email Council and the City Manager at council@sunnyvale.ca.gov and citymgr@sunnyvale.ca.gov

Artificial Turf in Sunnyvale

Artificial turf continues to be a popular topic of discussion in the Sunnyvale community. FUHSD needs to replace 12 old artificial fields at its high schools. If you are interested in voicing your support of using natural grass instead of artificial turf at these 12 fields, please sign this petition: tinyurl.com/FUHSD-Petition.

City Council is reviewing the next round of study issues for funding, including Study Issue ESD 24-01 ("Evaluate the Use of Artificial Turf versus Living Groundcovers"). More information about the City's study proposal process and timeline can be found at tinyurl.com/SunnyvaleStudies If you would like to share your opinion about the study issues, please email council@sunnyvale.ca.gov and cc citymgr@sunnyvale.ca.gov. Want to learn more? Contact Community for Natural Play Surfaces (CFNPS) at contactcfnps@gmail.com





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Important Numbers

Emergency
911

Abandoned Vehicles
(408) 730-7150

Shopping Carts & Graffiti
(408) 730-7680

Animal Control
(408) 730-7178

Parks & Maintenance
(408) 730-7506

Public Safety - Info
(408) 730-7100

Public Safety - Non-Emergency
(408) 730-7180

Street Lights/Sidewalks
(408) 730-7415

Street Trees/Parks
(408) 730-7505

Advertise in the Villager!!

Want to advertise in the Villager? Our printed newsletter goes to over 1600 homes in our neighborhood, and our electronic newsletter is sent out each month. It's a great, affordable way to publicize your business while support your neighborhood association. Please email vp1@lvnasv.org if you are interested in advertising. Prices are shown in the table.

Ad Size	For 1 printed issue	For 6 consecutive printed issues	For 12 consecutive printed issues
Business card	$40	$200	$380
Quarter page	$80	$400	$775
Half page	$160	$800	$1525
Full page	$320	$1600	$3100

Recap of Jan 10 General Meeting (Cont.)

Wondering about the FoodCycle program? In 2021, 65% of Sunnyvale residents participated in the program, which diverts 5000 tons of food per year from the landfill. FoodCycle is going to be even more important now. Recent state law SB1383 requires communities to reduce the amount of organics going into the landfill by 75% by 2025. All of the food that goes into the FoodCycle bin is used to generate electricity.

Some final food for thought:

- There's a reason the order is "reduce, reuse, recycle." Want to reduce your environmental footprint? First, reduce how much you buy. Second, reuse what you buy. And only then should you recycle it.
- Use the "Sunnyvale Recycles Right" app on your phone or the "How to Get Rid of Anything" feature on the City's website to check if something is recyclable.
- Remember, "when in doubt, throw it out - and remember the Nice Nine!", a digital copy is here: http://tinyurl.com/SunnyvaleRecycling

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